

Student Guide — primary / module-10-herbs-aushadhi

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

This workbook is yours to write in. Use it for vocab, exercises, and reflection across all 10 days.

Vocabulary tracker

Fill in as we go:

- *auṣadhi* — _____
- *tulasī* — _____
- *nimba* — _____
- *haridrā* — _____
- *ādraka* — _____
- *yavānī* — _____
- *pudīnā* — _____

Day-by-day notes

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

What I learned:

One question I have:

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

What I learned:

One question I have:

Final reflection

After Day 10, write a paragraph: what is the most important thing you learned in this module?

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: *"What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"*

Today's idea (10 min)

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. "medicinal plant / herb")
- *Auṣadhi* (say "OH-shudh-ee") = a plant that helps when we feel poorly.

Show six small plant samples or pictures. Pass each one — children smell, touch (carefully).

"Many plants are helpers! Today we meet six new garden friends." Each child draws one plant they liked best.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

- Citations belong in teacher notes only, not in student-facing material at this band.
- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify tulasī by leaf and smell; name the active compound (eugenol).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. “holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*”)
- Today: meet Tulsī! 🌿

Show a tulsī plant (or picture + dried leaf). - Smell it. “*What does it remind you of?*” (Spice. Mint. Tea.) - Tulsī tea is sometimes used when people feel a cold coming.

Children draw a tulsī leaf and write “tulasī” beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Identify nimba; learn about azadirachtin; understand high-dose safety warning.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. “neem — *Azadirachta indica*”)
- Today: meet Neem! 🌿

Show a neem leaf. “*Taste a TINY bit on your tongue — careful!*” (Bitter!) Children make faces — that’s OK, neem is meant to be bitter.

SAFETY RULE: Don’t eat lots of neem! Just a tiny taste to learn. Always ask a grown-up before using neem.

Children draw the leaf and write “neem” beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Distinguish fresh root vs powder; identify curcumin as active compound.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *haridrā* (IAST: haridrā; lit. “turmeric — *Curcuma longa*”)
- Today: meet Turmeric (Haldī)! 🌿

Show fresh turmeric root (or powder). “*It stains everything yellow!*” Drop a tiny amount on paper. Children watch the colour spread.

“*Golden milk = turmeric + warm milk + a bit of honey. People drink it when they feel poorly.*”

Children draw a yellow circle for the powder and write “haridrā” beside it.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Distinguish fresh vs dried; gingerol vs shogaol.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *ādraka* (IAST: ādraka; lit. “ginger — *Zingiber officinale*”)
- Today: meet Ginger (Adraka)! 🌿

Show fresh ginger root. “*It's bumpy, like a knobbly hand!*”

Smell it (mild). Then smell dried ginger powder (strong). “*Drying makes it stronger!*”

Ginger tea = ginger + warm water + a tiny bit of honey. People drink it when their tummy hurts.

Children draw ginger root with knobbly bumps.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Recognise seeds and leaves; identify thymol; traditional digestive use.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: “*What's one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today's idea (10 min)

- *yavānī* (IAST: *yavānī*; lit. “ajwain — *Trachyspermum ammi*”)
- Today: meet Ajwain (Yavānī)! 🌿

Show ajwain seeds. “*Tiny, like baby caraway.*” Smell them — strong! sharp!

“*People chew a few seeds after a big meal to help their tummy.*”

Children draw the seeds (small dots) and write “yavānī” beside.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Recognise several *Mentha* varieties; identify menthol.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: “*What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?*”

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *pudīnā* (IAST: pudīnā; lit. “mint — *Mentha* spp.”)

- Today: meet Mint (Pudīnā)! 🌿

Show fresh mint leaves. Smell — fresh, cool! Crush a leaf — smell stronger.

“Mint makes our mouth feel cool, even when it’s not cold!”

Mint chutney is yummy with food. Mint tea is good in summer.

Children draw a mint leaf (small, oval, slightly bumpy) and write “pudīnā” beside.

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas

Module: Herbs — Auśadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Categorise the six herbs by heating/cooling effect ([links to Module 4](#)).

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday’s lesson by asking: *“What’s one thing you remember from yesterday?”*

Today’s idea (10 min)

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)
- Each herb has a “temperature” inside us:
 - **Warm herbs:** ginger, ajwain (good when we feel cold/sick)
 - **Cool herbs:** mint, sometimes turmeric (good when we feel hot)

Match game: show pictures of the 6 herbs. Children sort into “warm” pile and “cool” pile.

“Warm herbs help in winter. Cool herbs help in summer.”

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 9 — Build the Class Deck

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Each student contributes one identification card to the class library.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See [lesson-plan.md](#) for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *tulasī* (IAST: tulasī; lit. "holy basil — *Ocimum tenuiflorum*")
- Today we make our class herb book!

Each child picks one favourite herb. They make a card: - Big drawing of the plant - Sanskrit name (the teacher helps write it) - One thing it does

Cards are taped together to make a class book. "This is OUR herb book!"

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see activities/). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See homework.md.)

Teacher notes

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- Keep new Sanskrit terms to one per lesson, repeated several times.
- If energy is low, swap the activity for free drawing.

Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Present the class herb deck; take summative quiz.

Materials

- Notebook, pencils, drawing paper
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

The flow

Settle + chant (3 min)

Daily chant or breathing exercise.

Story recall (4 min)

Briefly recall yesterday's lesson by asking: "What's one thing you remember from yesterday?"

Today's idea (10 min)

- *nimba* (IAST: nimba; lit. "neem — *Azadirachta indica*")
- Show-and-tell day!

Each child holds up their card and says ONE thing about their herb. Cheer for each.

Then quiz with stickers — everyone gets a "Garden Friend" sticker.

End: chant the six names together: "Tulasī! Nimba! Haridrā! Adraka! Yavānī! Pudīnā!"

Activity (8 min)

A simplified version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Draw, sing, or act it out.

Wrap-up (3 min)

Each child shares one word that describes today.

Homework

(See [homework.md](#).)

Teacher notes

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Homework

Homework — Herbs — Auṣadhi (Primary)

Light daily tasks. Each takes 5–10 minutes.

1. **Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
2. **Day 2 — Tulsī — Holy Basil** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
3. **Day 3 — Neem — Bitter Healer** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

4. **Day 4 — Turmeric — Golden Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
5. **Day 5 — Ginger — Warming Root** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
6. **Day 6 — Ajwain — Carom Seed** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
7. **Day 7 — Mint — Cooling Leaf** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
8. **Day 8 — Herbs and the Doṣas** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
9. **Day 9 — Build the Class Deck** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)
10. **Day 10 — Final Share and Assessment** · Draw about today's concept. (~5 min)

Notes

- Homework is intended to consolidate what was learned in class, not introduce new content.
- If a child struggles, the parent should consult the teacher rather than push.
- Capstone project days (Module 15) may have lighter daily homework so students can focus on the project.